

Rep. Tom Emmer on House Majority Whip joins Washington Watch with Tony Perkins

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JODY:

and more as the House Majority Whip. Tom Emmer, among other things, he serves on the House Financial Services Committee and he represents Minnesota's 6th Congressional District. Whip Emmer, great to see you again. Thanks for joining me on Washington Watch.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Good to see you, Jody.

JODY:

All right, let's start with your reaction to the Senate passing the continuing resolution, but not the Save America Act. What do you make of that?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, Jody, it's amazing that they got anything done because they really got very little done. I know they want you to think otherwise, but look at what the House did before we left. We've got the thinnest majority ever, I'm told, in history. We've done more since the beginning of Donald Trump's term with very few numbers than the Senate, quite frankly, has done in almost two years. I mean, you can point to the Genius Act and you can point to Reconciliation 1.0 that they had to move. It took them a month to get it out and back to us last summer. And quite frankly, if the White House hadn't weighed in last summer, they'd probably still be working on that too, Jody. Before we left, we passed a stock trading ban, we passed Reconciliation 3.0, and we passed a CR. What did they do? They passed their own CR, which has some anomalies in it that we'll have to see how those fly in the Senate. Ours went to December 4th and I believe theirs goes to December 10th or 11th. So that's what they accomplished before they left. And they left the signature piece of the president's agenda, the Save America Act, just sitting in place. Today, apparently, or yesterday, they had a vote before they left. Maybe it was Saturday early. They had a vote before they left on voter ID, something that they'd already passed. They'd already had a vote on it because they didn't want to make their members vote on the Save America Act. This is the way it works in Washington. You know this as well as anyone, Jody. You don't get anything done unless people are forced to put their vote up in front of God, their family, and America. And that's the way you pass things. We do it in the House all the time. The Senate tends to try to find ways not to put their vote up so people can see it. And if you can't pass an 80% issue out of the U.S. Senate, 80%, it's Republicans, Democrats, and others believe it is not unreasonable to have to prove you are a U.S. citizen for purposes of having the right to vote and that when you show up to cast a ballot, you should prove that, in fact, you are the citizen that you say you are in order to cast that ballot. That's an 80% issue in this country, Jody. You can't pass that through the Senate. I don't know what you're doing.

JODY:

Yeah, it's a great, great question. And hats off to you, your leadership, the House leadership, and the House overall. It really has been a stellar time passing so much out of the House. As the majority whip, what's gonna be on the agenda when the House returns this fall?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, we've still got a bunch of stuff to do. We not only have the rest of the appropriations bills that have to come across the floor, we've got a surface transportation reauthorization that's gotta be done by September 30th. You've still got the FISA issue that's sitting out there, which, foolishly, Democrats in the Senate have been sparring about. They'd rather put Americans' safety in play than over their politics, their political games, than keep us safe. You've got the NDAA that we sent over to the Senate before we left. That has to get done. These are all things that have to get done. I would say to you, though, Jody, it's very possible that we see a continued resolution get done when we get back, which then puts everything on hold until after the election. And that's very possible. We'll just have to wait and see what our speaker, Mike Johnson, and the leader in the Senate, John Thune, have planned when we get back.

JODY:

Yeah, a lot on the agenda. What about the issue of fraud? I know the president's put forth an initiative to try to combat fraud at all levels. What role do you anticipate Congress playing in all that?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, Congress has already played a major role. Your former colleague and our friend, Jamie Comer, the chairman of the House Oversight Committee, and, in fact, our friend, Jim Jordan, the chairman of the Judiciary Committee, have both had a big part to play in the fraud investigations in the House. I mean, it all started with Doge. Every member of the president's cabinet, he has given them a mission to go find the waste, fraud, and abuse, and eliminate it. He's assigned J.D. Vance, his great vice president, to actually lead the charge across the country. And now you have Todd Blanche, the newly minted attorney general that's going to carry on where Pam Bondi left off. And, you know, as a representative from the state of Minnesota, we know the fraud issue very, very well.

JODY:

Right. Somali fraud-

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, I wanted to put that out to you.

JODY:

Yes, like crazy.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, well, yeah, you've got a state where this has been huge, and we've only got about a minute left.

JODY:

So what's the latest effort to root out fraud and to hold those accountable who are responsible in your home state?

REP. TOM EMMER:

That is the issue, is it's holding them accountable, but rooting it out. You've got to expose this. You know, in the short time you have left, keep in mind, \$250 million pandemic fraud case, largest pandemic fraud case, defeating our future scandal. They've indicted about 96 people. I think 86 of them, 87 of them are Somalis, the Somali fraudsters that are involved. You know who they didn't indict? They didn't indict one government official. That's where the issue is. Somebody was overseeing the millions of dollars, the hundreds of millions that were being stolen right out from under the nose of Tim Walz and Keith Ellison. That's where the accountability has to happen now, Jody.

JODY:

Well, you've been on the tip of the spear on that issue, and I want to thank you for your leadership, and thank you for joining us today on Washington Watch. Congressman Tom Emmer, House Majority Whip. Always great to see you.

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